SEMP Public Transport Disruption Sub-Plan



Edition 3 – October 2024

VICTORIA State Government | Department of Transport and Planning

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Authority

This plan has been endorsed by the State Crisis and Resilience Council (SCRC) as a Sub-Plan to the State Emergency Management Plan on 10 October 2024.

Authorised and published by

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Version

This is the third version of a state-level plan addressing public transport disruption arrangements. The first two versions were developed by the Department of Transport and Planning's preceding departments – the Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources in 2016, and Department of Transport in 2020, for public transport disruption emergencies.

We proudly acknowledge Victoria's First Nations people and their ongoing strength in practising the world's oldest living culture. We acknowledge the Traditional Owners of the lands and waters on which we live and work and pay our respects to their Elders past and present.

Description of artwork

Aaron (Gunaikurnai) 'Movements Between the Five Clans' 2019, acrylic on canvas.

'The tracks are going between the five clans of the Gunaikurnai and the hands are the symbols of my spirit travelling around the campsites.'

This artwork was created through programs provided by the Torch. The Torch provides art, cultural and arts industry support to Indigenous offenders and ex-offenders in Victoria. The Torch aims to reduce the rate of re-offending by encouraging the exploration of identity and culture through art programs to define new pathways upon release.



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1151
PT


RAIL
CROSSING
WAY
STOP
ON RED
SIGNAL
RAILWAY


3002
PT


6089
PT


Via City Loop

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose

This State Emergency Management Plan (SEMP) Sub-Plan is for significant and protracted public transport disruptions, caused by a transport infrastructure or signalling failure that is not a result of another emergency. The Public Transport Disruption Sub-Plan applies to emergencies only and does not relate to planned disruptions or operational incidents.

This Sub-Plan complements the SEMP by providing detail of specific arrangements for public transport disruptions, where DTP is either the control agency or a support agency.

For the purposes of the *Emergency Management Act 2013* (Vic) (EM Act 2013) and Ministerial Guidelines, statewide response arrangements for a public transport disruption are implemented at Level 3 of this Sub-Plan. Operational and regionally based events are managed in accordance with Level 1 (operator) and Level 2 (departmental) response. These are included in the Sub-Plan for completeness and for support agency functions, noting the majority of public transport disruptions in Victoria are a consequence of other emergencies. Where control for an event is vested in another agency under the SEMP (or alternative Sub-Plan) this plan will be used as a guide and will not be formally enacted.

This Sub-Plan does not duplicate the content of the SEMP or other plans referenced.

The Department of Transport and Planning (DTP) has developed this Public Transport Disruption Sub-Plan in consultation with the transport sector and other stakeholders. This Plan is written in accordance with the EM Act 2013 and the Ministerial Guidelines for Preparing State, Regional and Municipal Emergency Management Plans.

For the purposes of this Sub-Plan, public transport disruptions do not include maritime, marine passenger transport or aviation transport modes. Emergencies impacting marine passenger transport and ferry services are covered by the SEMP (for search and rescue arrangements), and the SEMP Maritime Emergencies (Non-Search and Rescue) Sub-Plan for vessel casualties.

1.2 Aim

In keeping with all emergency management plans in Victoria, this Sub-Plan aims to:

- foster a sustainable and efficient emergency management system that minimises the likelihood, effect and consequences of a public transport disruption, and
- establish governance arrangements for public transport disruptions which occur as a result of emergencies that:
  - clarify the roles and responsibilities of agencies, including public transport operators,
  - facilitate cooperation between agencies, including public transport operators,
  - provide for the coordination of emergency management arrangements with the public transport sector.

1.3 Preparation, approval and publication

The State Crisis and Resilience Council (SCRC) approved this sub-plan to take effect on 10 October 2024 and it is available on the Emergency Management Victoria (EMV) website. This Plan will be reviewed no later than October 2027.

EMV will provide a copy of the published plan to the State Library of Victoria within two months of the date of publication, in accordance with the legal deposit requirements in section 49 of the *Libraries Act 1988* (Vic).

1.4 Audience

The primary audience for this Sub-Plan is anyone involved in the management and governance of Victorian public transport disruptions including employees of DTP, public transport operators, government departments and emergency service agencies.

1.5 Definitions

This plan refers to:

- '*Transport sector*', when collectively referring to the organisations providing transport services in Victoria. This is broader than the scope of this plan and includes road transport and freight.
- '*Public transport operator*' when referring to the individual organisations responsible for specific aspects of the transport network which carry passengers, including the train network (metropolitan and regional), tram network and bus network.
- '*Public transport disruption*', when referring to a situation where the public transport operator's ability to operate its contracted scheduled services is impeded, due to an emergency.

Acronyms and further definitions used in this Sub-Plan are listed in Appendix A – Acronyms, and Appendix B – Definitions.

1.6 Legislation

The following key legislation applies to the management of public transport disruption emergencies:

- *Emergency Management Act 2013* (Vic)
- *Rail Safety National Law Application Act 2013* (Vic)
- *Transport Integration Act 2010* (Vic).

Other legislation may relate to safety or specific aspects of the transport operations.

1.7 Contractual Arrangements

Public transport services in Victoria are managed via franchise or service level agreements. While the arrangements in this Sub-Plan are consistent to the greatest extent possible, should operational discrepancies arise, the EM Act 2013 (s. 60AK) notes that contractual arrangements will take precedence.

1.8 Linked plans

Other plans and procedures exist which set out coordination arrangements during emergencies. To avoid duplication, the detail of the following linked plans and procedures is not repeated within this Sub-Plan.

State Emergency Management Plan (SEMP)

The SEMP outlines the emergency management arrangements in Victoria to inform planning at state, regional and municipal levels. It provides a coordinated and comprehensive approach to emergency management at the state level for mitigation of, response to and recovery from emergencies and specifies the roles and responsibilities of agencies.

DTP Emergency Management Plan

DTP has an Emergency Management Plan that outlines its role and internal governance structures for managing emergencies.

Public transport operator emergency and crisis management plan

Each public transport operator is required to plan, maintain and exercise an emergency and crisis management plan in accordance with its Franchise or Service Level Agreement with DTP and regulatory requirements.

Public transport operator procedures

Each public transport operator has operational procedures/plans to prepare for and respond to a transport service disruption – including restoration of services.

Regional and Municipal Emergency Management Plans

Regional and municipal emergency management planning committees must produce regional and municipal emergency management plans (REMPs and MEMPs).

REMPs and MEMPs include regional and municipal agency arrangements for the response to transport service disruption, where appropriate.

2. VICTORIA'S TRANSPORT SECTOR

2.1 The transport system

Victoria's transport system is a geographically spread and complex network of public transport and freight rail infrastructure that underpins much of the state's economic and social functioning. Victoria's public transport system comprises heavy rail (train), light rail (tram), and buses, and may rely on parts of the road network.

There are key nodes which are critical to the operation of the system. These include bridges, intermodal hubs and depots. Loss of these nodes could significantly impact the community and the Victorian economy.

To maintain safe, effective and reliable operations, the tram and train networks rely on a range of physical, electromechanical and electronic infrastructure elements, including extensive communications infrastructure.

Loss of Victoria's transport system would have a downstream impact on many critical services that rely on the transport sector for the movement of goods and transport of essential workers. At the same time, the transport sector has significant dependencies on the energy sector for electricity and liquid fuels as an input to all transport modes.

2.2 Department of Transport and Planning

DTP is responsible for planning, building and operating an integrated, sustainable and safe public transport system for Victoria.

The Head, Transport for Victoria (Head, TfV) is the legal entity responsible for coordinating, providing, operating and maintaining the public transport system and the road networks in Victoria. The Head, TfV is a statutory authority (rather than a person) established by the *Transport Integration Act 2010* (Vic) section 64A and incorporates the road management responsibilities of the Roads Corporation (VicRoads). The Secretary DTP is accountable for the functions of the Head, TfV.

As stated in the SEMP, the Head, TfV provides oversight of public transport operations, control centres and communication networks to ensure they are functioning effectively. These include the:

- Melbourne metropolitan rail network (maintained via franchise agreement)
- Melbourne tram network (maintained via franchise agreement)
- Melbourne metropolitan, regional and Department of Education school bus networks
- Intrastate rail network (maintained and operated by V/Line)
- Interstate rail lines (maintained and operated by the Australian Rail Track Corporation).

Section 3.1 of this Sub-Plan describes how DTP delivers its control agency function.

The Secretary DTP is the officer-in-charge (DTP OIC) for the purposes of the EM Act 2013 and the SEMP, and is a member of the State Crisis and Resilience Council (SCRC).

2.3 VicTrack

VicTrack provides a telecommunications network to support Victoria's train and tram networks.

VicTrack owns Victoria's rail transport land, assets and infrastructure. VicTrack leases land, infrastructure and assets to DTP for tram, metropolitan and regional train services. In turn, DTP operates public transport services via franchise or service level agreements. The respective public transport operator is responsible for managing and maintaining the assets.

2.4 Public transport operators

Public transport operators are responsible for delivering, or facilitating the delivery of, public transport services across the passenger transport modes of rail (both metropolitan and regional), tram, road (metropolitan and regional buses) and ferries. They provide these services in accordance with a relevant franchise or service level agreement with DTP and include providing communication and advice on disruptions or service alterations to passengers during an emergency event.

Under these agreements and relating to the services they operate, each public transport operator is responsible for the mitigation of, preparedness for, and the on-ground response to service disruptions, and for the restoration and recovery of these services. A public transport operator may provide support to other public transport operators facing service disruption and can be directed (at Departmental cost) to provide additional services or support where it has capacity to do so.

Each public transport operator outlines its arrangements for undertaking these responsibilities in its emergency and crisis management plan, required under the agreement.

2.5 Public transport disruptions

Public transport disruptions can be planned or unplanned. Public transport operators must notify passengers of planned and unplanned disruptions and provide them with alternate travel details and advice as soon as reasonably practicable (see s 3.3.1 below). While the causes of unplanned disruptions can be emergency or non-emergency situations, this plan applies to emergencies only, including severe weather events (where DTP would be a support agency), or significant public transport asset faults/ failures.

Planned disruptions due to scheduled asset maintenance by public transport operators or the occupation of parts of the rail and road network for major transport infrastructure projects are outside the scope of this plan.

2.5.1 Potential consequences of a public transport disruption

Most significant public transport disruptions are likely to be caused by other emergencies (see 3.2). However, the potential consequences of a transport service disruption (however caused) may include:

- people consequences
  - injury/death
  - crowding and congestion – particularly where a shift to other modes is needed
  - impact on community members who rely on public transport, including those at greater risk in emergencies
  - passenger health and safety risks (including from heatwave/ weather impacts)
  - security risks
- economic consequences
  - impact on the movement of essential workers
  - impact on the movement of goods
  - impact on supply chains
- environmental consequences
  - damage to roads, bridges, tunnels and facilities
  - damage to railway and tram lines, network infrastructure, signalling, communications, facilities and assets
  - damage to other public transport infrastructure
- public administration consequences
  - loss of staff and contractors
  - reduction in services and ability of public transport operators to meet service performance targets
  - absenteeism
- social consequences
  - impact on transport routes and the movement of people for school, work, shopping, healthcare and medical appointments, family or social interaction etc
  - restricted access to essential goods/freight.

3. MITIGATION

3.1 Control agency planning and preparedness

The SEMP lists control agencies for each form of emergency.

The EM Act 2013 defines the Control Agency as the agency with primary responsibility for responding to a specific form of emergency. The SEMP adds that the control agency is also responsible for establishing the management arrangements for an integrated response to the emergency.

The SEMP prescribes that DTP is the control agency for essential service disruption to public transport, major arterial roads, bridges, tunnels and rail networks.

Whilst DTP is responsible for management and coordination of the event, it is important to note that most public transport disruptions are a consequence of emergencies where there is another control agency. Circumstances where DTP is the control agency generally include infrastructure failures or protracted and widespread loss of critical train/tram controlling or signalling systems.

DTP undertakes its responsibility by:

- coordinating an effective response by the public transport operators and providing assurance to the Secretary DTP that effective control has been established (refer to Appendix B – Definitions for a definition of 'effective control'),
- making sure that the public transport operator response is timely and properly coordinated, in liaison with Departmental emergency portfolio leads and emergency services, as necessary, and
- providing Whole of Victorian Government (WoVG) guidance and assistance to public transport operators or other agencies, where required, to bring events to a satisfactory conclusion for the Victorian community.

The SEMP identifies that DTP will respond by:

- providing immediate assistance or support in co-ordination of private rail, tram, bus, contracted ferry organisations, road contractor and other organisations related to emergencies involving loss of life, injury to persons, fire, hazardous chemical accidents, general policing incidents and other major emergencies,
- providing and facilitating professional and skilled engineering and technical emergency teams/experts, equipment and material to other emergencies from either DTP, public transport operators or contractors as appropriate,
- providing relevant support to other agencies in the management of emergencies including but not limited to information, expertise, specialist equipment, and facilitating access to networks, and
- liaising with relevant industry sectors to facilitate response to a disruption to essential services, except for a disruption to roads.

This Sub-Plan has been developed to address DTP's responsibility as control agency to develop a hazard-specific response plan for transport service disruptions.

Additionally, in preparedness for emergencies, DTP will:

- prepare, maintain and exercise emergency management plans,
- provide leadership to the sector in the development, implementation and evaluation of multi-agency exercises, including annual public transport operator critical infrastructure exercises, according to Part 7A of the EM Act 2013,
- chair and participate in public and private sector emergency committees,
- participate in state, regional and national (where required) emergency management meetings, forums, and/or exercises to provide advice on behalf of the public transport sector,
- maintain readiness to coordinate the emergency response by public transport operators,
- plan, with other agencies, to manage incidents on major arterial roads, including planning diversion routes for different classes of vehicles,
- assist public transport operators to enact their emergency and crisis management plans when required,

- lead and participate in sector specific preparedness briefings including:
  - summer season preparedness briefings
  - briefings on whole-of-government emergency preparedness
  - regional and state tier emergency management information updates
  - briefing transport minister/s in relation to emergency preparedness and mitigation.

Public transport operator preparedness is outlined in section 3.3.

3.2 Response support agency planning and preparedness

Many public transport disruptions occur as a consequence of other emergencies, controlled by other agencies. These other emergencies include:

- an earthquake, flood, windstorm, heatwave or another natural event
- a fire
- an explosion
- a road accident or any other accident
- a plague, pandemic, epidemic or contamination (including radiological/biological)
- a warlike act or act of terrorism
- a hi-jack, siege or riot
- a cyber-security attack
- failure of infrastructure
- an electricity outage.

In these emergencies DTP is a response support agency, in consultation with public transport operators. The role of response support agencies is listed in the SEMP.

Response support agencies are required to plan to act in line with the agency's legislative and administrative responsibilities and SEMP arrangements.

3.3 Public transport operator planning and preparedness

3.3.1 Public transport operator agreements with DTP

DTP has an agreement with each public transport operator for the provision of services and these include the requirement for each operator to plan, maintain and exercise emergency and crisis management plans in accordance with its regulatory requirements, as well as a business continuity plan. The public transport operator is accountable for ensuring the adequacy of its plans, including conducting an annual review.

In addition to agreements with the public transport operators, the Government also has a services and development agreement with Southern Cross Station.

Further, in preparedness for emergencies, public transport operators and stakeholders will:

- participate in multi-agency exercises,
- participate in public and private sector emergency management committees,
- participate in state, regional and national (where required) emergency management meetings, forums, and/or exercises to provide advice on behalf of the public transport sector,
- undertake seasonal risk mitigation activities and maintain readiness to respond,
- participate in preparedness briefings where held, including:
  - summer season preparedness briefings
  - briefings on whole-of-government emergency preparedness
  - regional and state tier emergency management information updates
  - input to briefing transport minister/s in relation to emergency preparedness and mitigation.

Each public transport operator is also required to notify public transport disruptions to DTP, in line with existing processes and procedures. The following updates are coordinated by DTP and public transport operators to the community during an emergency:

- notification of network disruptions,
- provision of advice on alternate travel options,
- provision of safe alternate travel services.

3.3.2 Maintenance schedules and routine inspections

Each public transport operator maintains regular maintenance schedules and routine inspections relating to infrastructure they own or manage.

A well-maintained system will increase passenger comfort and improve reliability by reducing the risk of potential power outages and signal failures so far as reasonably practicable, thus reducing the number of delayed trains providing a safer and more punctual service network. Asset renewal and upgrades include:

- modernised signalling systems,
- bridge replacement works,
- rail grinding on the regional network,
- auditing of rail easement fire mitigation programs, and
- adverse weather delay protection including lightning strike and track buckling in hot weather.

3.4 Major infrastructure projects

Before this Sub-Plan's next regular review, Victoria is delivering over 201 major road and rail projects, including:

- the Metro Tunnel, a second underground railway for Melbourne, with 5 new stations
- removal of 110 level crossings across Melbourne
- the West Gate Tunnel, an alternative to the West Gate Bridge
- the North East Link, linking Melbourne's freeway network
- major road upgrades around Victoria, including new roads, road widenings, new bridges and major freeway upgrades
- major rail upgrades across the network

These projects and potential future projects may result in, or be affected by, emergencies during their construction phase. The Victorian Infrastructure Delivery Authority (VIDA) will implement relevant emergency and crisis management plans, where applicable, in the event of an emergency affecting key projects. VIDA's role will be responsible for overseeing the safe delivery of the transport infrastructure program through its project delivery partners.

VIDA's own crisis management plan outlines how it will undertake reporting processes to DTP, government and other emergency services for either an external emergency event or a VIDA crisis event. Where relevant, a VIDA representative would be embedded in DTP's emergency management structures.

The delivery of or significant changes to these projects may trigger an out-of-cycle review or update of this Sub-Plan.


071Z-0179
BOX HILL
VIA CAMBERWELL 612
VOLGREN
PT
CDC MELBOURNE
BS07 1Z

4. TRANSPORT COORDINATION GROUP

Where multiple public transport operators are affected by an emergency, a transport coordination group (TCG) – or a consultative group which includes a subset of public transport operators depending on the nature of the disruption – may be activated to coordinate actions across the sector.

DTP will convene a TCG if formally acting as a support agency for another statewide emergency, unless other standing arrangements are in place via the SEMP or another specific Sub-Plan.

4.1 Purpose

A TCG may be convened to coordinate the preparedness, readiness, response or recovery plans for activities impacting the transport network during support or control emergency arrangements. The TCG is a transport-specific sub-group at incident level, however can feed into the broader Emergency Management Team (EMT) as required.

During an emergency, or in readiness for an emergency:

- DTP provides information on the state situation, the State (or Regional or Area of Control) Controller's intent and the incident objectives
- public transport operators provide information on the activities they intend to undertake to address the disruption, reinstate infrastructure or otherwise support the relevant controller.

TCG information contributes to situation awareness and intelligence gathering, identifying the actions of the sector in response to and to manage the emergency or threat. This includes identification and management of risks across the sector in alignment with government priorities.

The individual public transport operator and member organisation is responsible for implementing actions arising from a TCG and will report through their internal command structures.

4.2 Outputs

The outputs of any TCG meeting may be presented to:

- DTP's executive emergency management oversight and governance group, and the Executive or internal governance of any operator or agency involved,
- the State EMT (SEMT) by the DTP State Agency Commander (SAC)[1] or delegate,
- the relevant Regional EMT (REMT) by DTP Regional Agency Commander (RAC) or delegate,
- the relevant public transport emergency management officer or delegate.

1. The process for appointing the DTP SAC and the DTP RAC, where required, is contained within the DTP Emergency Management Plan.

5. RESPONSE: DTP CONTROL ARRANGEMENTS

This section outlines the arrangements for control, command, coordination, consequence management, communications and relief for emergencies where DTP is the control agency.

Relief is defined in the SEMP as the provision of assistance to meet the essential needs of individuals, families and communities during and in the immediate aftermath of an emergency. The SEMP sets out relief responsibilities for government departments and agencies, the principles for the coordination and delivery of relief, and contains information on broadscale relief considerations that may be required during a public transport disruption emergency.

Relief is a component of response per the SEMP. The extent and nature of the consequences of an emergency event will dictate the relief support required as described in the SEMP.

5.1 DTP's control agency scenarios

Public transport disruption situations where DTP is the control agency include:

- infrastructure failure, (not associated with severe weather or other emergencies where there is another control agency), including communication failure and power outages at major transport hubs,
- network delays and service outages caused by infrastructure faults, operator issues/ industrial action,
- telecommunications disruptions – loss of critical train/tram controlling or signaling systems.

Public transport disruptions which occur as a consequence of another emergency are managed through control arrangements under the SEMP, or the relevant Sub-Plan. In this instance, DTP and operators will act as a support agency. Section 6 of this Sub-Plan provides further information.

5.2 DTP's control levels

In line with the SEMP, Victoria has three operational tiers (incident, regional and state) with the option of an 'area of operations' being declared to manage a complex emergency that may be geographically located over several municipalities or several regions. These tiers are usually activated in line with the following levels to emergencies controlled by DTP:

- **Level 1 – Single operator response,**
- **Level 2 – Regional response or Area-of-Operations (AoO) response,**
- **Level 3 – State tier response.**

5.3 Appointment of controllers

Persons to perform the role of State Controller, Regional Controller or AoO Controller if required are to work on behalf of the Secretary DTP (as the representative of the Victorian State Government), rather than on behalf of their agency.

The Secretary DTP is to ensure there is an appropriate trained, accredited and experienced State Controller appointed where required and is to provide the Emergency Management Commissioner (EMC) with their details.

The State Controller has all the powers of the control agency officer in charge (OIC). The State Controller appoints Regional Controllers as required. The Regional Controller has all the powers of the control agency OIC. The State Controller in consultation with the Secretary DTP may appoint a Deputy State Controller/s as Subject Matter Experts to support the Controller and response.

AoO Controllers, if required, will be appointed by the State Controller in consultation with the Secretary DTP. They may also be sourced from public transport operators.

These persons may be sourced from across the transport sector or broader emergency management sector (with their agreement) and are to be confirmed by the Secretary DTP. The person to whom control is transferred must agree to the transfer and it must be enacted through an instrument of appointment.

The person to whom control is transferred then acquires the powers and responsibilities as specified in the instrument of appointment. Where control is transferred to person or persons from another agency, DTP must supply an experienced Subject Matter Expert (SME) as Deputy Controller.

All persons must be suitably trained, qualified and experienced to perform the role and remain current with the Victorian emergency management arrangements.

The Secretary DTP must notify the EMC of the appointment of a State Controller.

5.4 Level 1 – single operator response

Typical Level 1 scenarios are operational incidents. State level control arrangements under this Sub-Plan are not activated for Level 1 scenarios. These scenarios may include:

- cancellation of services
- rolling stock or network infrastructure faults or emergencies
- minor infrastructure and resource planning issues.

A Level 1 response involves:

- response by a single public transport operator. This may include limited support from other agencies, such as assistance with alternative transport options
- little or no community consequences
- normal resolution of services within a 4-hour period.

At Level 1, a public transport disruption is normally managed by the public transport operator as part of business-as-usual arrangements, through the exercise of its operational or emergency management plans in consultation with DTP as required.

Multiple Level 1 responses may occur concurrently. A Level 2 response and the activation of a TCG should be considered where:

- the incident response becomes an emergency and is anticipated to last for more than 4 hours, or
- multiple public transport operators are using the same support resources/services, or
- there is a risk of consequences or impacts of the emergency becoming more serious, or
- the actions/public communications of multiple public transport operators need to be coordinated.

FUNCTION	DESCRIPTION (LEVEL 1)	RESPONSIBLE PERSON
Command	The operator's normal supervisory structure applies.	Site manager – public transport operator
Control	An Incident Controller is only required where multiple agencies are involved, or the impacts or consequences may significantly escalate. The site manager may concurrently perform the command and control functions.	Incident Controller (public transport operator)
Oversight of control	Oversight of effective control on behalf of DTP as the control agency.	Department Transport Operations Centre (TOC) supported as required by the DTP State Agency Commander
Coordination	Generally not required. Where required, support resources are sourced from the local area.	Incident Emergency Response Coordinator (Victoria Police)
Communication	Advice to passengers of network disruptions and advice on alternate travel options.	Public transport operators site manager / Incident Controller
Consequence management	Minimal customer, public or infrastructure impact.	Public transport operator site manager / Incident Controller
Relief	Information and support to customers, where required. Provision of immediate health, wellbeing, financial or essential needs of affected persons.	Public transport operators As outlined in the SEMP
Support to the controller	Support to the site manager / Incident Controller (e.g., assistance with communications, provision of relief etc).	Normal public transport operator business support functions
Notification	Notification to DTP and subsequent updates and eventual ALL CLEAR via standard communication tool (i.e. SMS or similar).	Public transport operator site manager / Incident Controller
Recovery	Restoration of normal services	Public transport operator site manager / Incident Controller

Each public transport operator is required to provide the following information to the community and DTP:

- notification of network disruptions
- provision of advice on alternate travel options
- provision of safe alternate travel services.

5.5 Level 2 – Department area of operation or regional tier activated

A Level 2 response to a public transport disruption may be required where the emergency:

- may have (including the risk of) a medium-term impact on critical infrastructure
- requires a limited response by multiple public transport operators
- may have (including the risk of) an impact on the community for longer than 4 hours.

Typical Level 2 response scenarios where DTP may be the control agency include:

- prolonged telecommunication outage possibly causing major critical (train/tram controlling) network signalling issues
- disruption caused by capital works
- a situation where a public transport operator is unable to deliver services, and/or the services of multiple public transport operators are affected,
- transport disruption situations anticipated to take longer than 4 hours to resolve, or through timing will have significant impacts on the community.

A Level 2 transport service disruption is managed through activation of Department AoO and/or via regional control arrangements – but may be managed at the Department level or State tier under certain circumstances. Note that this is in addition to the response by public transport operators at the incident tier.

A Level 2 response can potentially escalate into a Level 3 response. Control of a Level 2 transport service disruption must be transferred to the State tier (i.e, become a Level 3 incident) as soon as possible if:

- the scenario shows clear potential to become a major emergency (refer to Appendix B – Definitions)
- the DTP AoO or Regional Controller needs immediate specialist/additional support
- several similar emergencies are expected within the area and are best managed as a single control structure.

5.5.1 Level 2 – Regional tier activated

The Regional tier (and/or State tier) is activated for a Level 2 response where multiple agency support within a Victorian government region is needed. Activation would be determined by DTP's State Controller in consultation with DTP and the EMC. The EMC is responsible for ensuring DTP establishes effective control of emergencies.

A multi-agency regional response is managed by:

- activation of regional tier arrangements in addition to DTP's incident tier arrangements,
- a Regional Controller supported by the business functions of the affected PT operator. The role statement for a Regional Controller is in the SEMP,
- a TCG and Department's Executive Coordination Team (ECT) to provide support as required.
- DTP's RAC or senior delegate must attend the REMT to provide technical input into regional discussions. The Regional Agency Commander may be supported by a SME.

The Regional tier remains activated whilst multiple agency support is required to respond to the public transport disruption or security event.

FUNCTION	DESCRIPTION (LEVEL 2)	RESPONSIBLE PERSON (AND APPOINTMENT)
Control	Control is exercised across multiple public transport operators within the activated Region	Regional Controller (appointed by a Department Executive or the State Controller - if appointed)
	Oversight of effective control (on behalf of DTP as control agency).	Department Regional or State Agency Commander supported by an IMT (if established), a TCG if convened, the DTP Emergency ECT and State Agency Commander as required
Command	Supervision remains within each agency (i.e. each responding public transport operator).	Department Regional Agency Commander and public transport operator commanders
Coordination (support agencies)	Coordination of support agencies and chair of the REMT	Regional Emergency Response Coordinator (RERC)
Coordination (public transport operators)	The TCG coordinates the activities of multiple public transport operators (as support agencies)	Convener TCG and ECT as required
Communication	– Public communications and warnings – Government and stakeholder communications Communications would be through the normal transport communication media (websites and social media, etc.)	Regional Controller (supported by DTP)
Consequence management	Customer, public or infrastructure impact managed by each response agency	Regional Controller/Regional Agency Commander supported by TCG and ECT
Relief	Provision of immediate health, wellbeing, financial or essential needs of affected persons.	As outlined in the SEMP
Support	Support to the Regional Controller.	Public transport operator's normal business functions
Notification	As part of the first response, the public transport operator must notify the DTP Operational Response Duty Officer on 1800 961 311.	Regional Controller
Recovery	Recovery coordination	Emergency Recovery Victoria (ERV)
	Overall responsibility for leading the recovery of: – restoration of major arterial roads, bridges and tunnels – restoration of tram, bus, rail services.	DTP
	Overall responsibility for supporting the recovery of: – restoration of major arterial roads, bridges and tunnels – restoration of tram, bus, rail services.	Recovery support agencies: – ERV and EMV – Public transport operators – VicTrack – Victorian Managed Insurance Authority (VMIA) – Road operators The SEMP Roles and Responsibilities provides detailed information on agency roles and responsibilities for recovery

5.5.2 Level 2 – AoO activated

The AoO is activated for a Level 2 response where multiple Public Transport Operators from the same or different Victorian Government regions are responding to the emergency, however this response is largely confined to a public transport issue and the operational support of multiple emergency services agencies is not required.

A typical Level 2 response scenario where an AoO and support team may need to be established includes where the emergency:

- spans several regions, such as across the Melbourne metropolitan area (this is a geographic AoO).
- affects a single aspect of transport that is widespread, such as a rail line or network which crosses multiple regional boundaries (this is a functional AoO) – note greater or extended network impacts may be Level 3.
- affects multiple operators responding across multiple regions.

If an AoO is established, it will operate as a regional tier as described in section 5.2.1.

5.6 Level 3 – State tier activated

Level 3 response arrangements are typically activated where the public transport disruption emergency:

- has (or potentially has) a significant economic, social or environmental impact to the state of Victoria, or
- has (or potentially has) a major impact on the routine functioning of the community and requires a Whole-of-Victorian-Government response.

Potential scenarios for Level 3 responses controlled by DTP include:

- widespread and protracted telecommunications outage potentially causing signalling issues and failures to communicate with transport nodes for a significant and prolonged period,
- prolonged and complete suspension of the metropolitan or regional train / tram network,
- significant social or economic impacts,
- a major infrastructure failure with the risk of loss of life and multiple injuries.

Typically, a Level 3 response requires:

- a response beyond the capacity of the transport sector and/or a regional response requiring a multi-agency statewide response,
- a significant time period for the emergency to resolve.



Activation of the State tier involves the WoVG response to manage the impact and consequences of the emergency. Figure 1 describes the structures and information flows to support this function.

A Level 3 response is managed through:

- the appointment of a State Controller Transport by the Secretary DTP,
- the State Controller will establish a control structure for the disruption (in accordance with AIIMS, and with internal governance oversighted by the DTP internal ECT and/or Department Executive Emergency Team (DEET). This is likely to include:
  - establishment of regional emergency management arrangements
  - public transport operators continuing to respond at the incident tier, according to their emergency management plans, with their activities coordinated through a TCG
  - convening the State Control Team, State Emergency Management Team, Regional Emergency Management Teams and local Incident Emergency Management Teams as required to coordinate whole-of-government actions to manage the wider community consequences
  - DTP's internal ECT and DEET providing support.

The EMC will monitor the control of the emergency and the State Control Centre (SCC) will provide support as required.

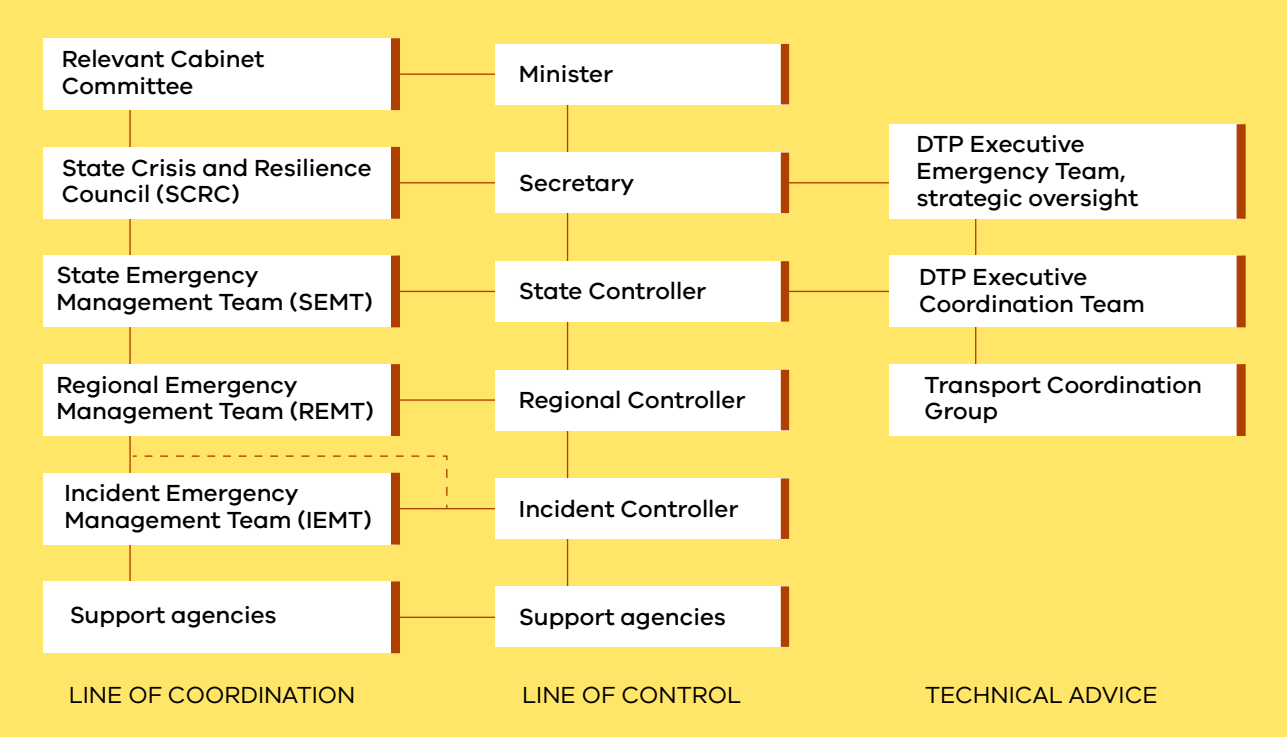


Figure 1: DTP coordination, control and advice structures

FUNCTION	DESCRIPTION (LEVEL 3)	RESPONSIBLE PERSON (AND APPOINTMENT)
Control	State tier control, exercised at the State Control Centre (SCC)	State Controller[2] (appointed by the Secretary DTP)
	Regional or AoO control (where required) to manage specific areas or functions of the response (e.g., train or tram response)	Regional and/or AoO Controller (appointed by the State Controller or Secretary DTP)
	Oversight of effective control	Secretary DTP and EMC
Command	Supervision remains within each responding public transport operator.	State and Regional Agency Commanders and public transport operators
Coordination (support agencies)	SEMT (and REMT as required) will convene to coordinate the activities of the whole-of-government to manage the broader consequences of the emergency.	State Controller, EMC and Regional Emergency Response Coordinators, as required)
Coordination (transport operators)	DTP's ECT supported by the Transport Coordination Group (TCG) coordinates the activities of multiple transport operators (as support agencies)	Chair ECT Chair TCG
Communication	Emergency Management Joint Public Information Committee (EMJPIC) to coordinate: – Public communications and warnings – Government and stakeholder communications	State Controller (in collaboration with the EMC)
	Public transport operator command communications	Each transport operator, through its chain of command
Consequence management	Coordinated through SEMT and REMT (where required)	EMC and RERC
	Each public transport operator to manage its immediate and operational customer, public or infrastructure impacts. Alternative transport options and routes during prolonged response or recovery periods will be coordinated by DTP.	Public transport operators, DTP and DEET
Relief	Provision of immediate health, wellbeing, financial or essential needs of affected persons	As outlined in the SEMP

2. The Secretary DTP must notify the EMC when a State Controller is appointed.

FUNCTION	DESCRIPTION (LEVEL 3)	RESPONSIBLE PERSON (AND APPOINTMENT)
Support to the controller	Support to the State Controller	DTP's ECT with support from the SCC
	Support to the Regional or AoO Controller	Public transport operator normal business functions Regional Control Centres
	Support to public transport operator response	Each public transport operator
Notification	Notify the EMC for a Class 2 emergency, or Notify the EMC and Chief Commissioner of Police for a Class 3 emergency, noting transfer of control to police would occur for Class 3.	State Controller (or State Agency Commander if State Controller not yet appointed)
	The Secretary DTP must notify the EMC when a State Controller is appointed.	Secretary DTP
Recovery	Recovery coordination	ERV
	Overall responsibility for leading the recovery of: – restoration of major arterial roads, bridges and tunnels – restoration of tram, bus, rail services.	DTP
	Overall responsibility for supporting the recovery of: – restoration of major arterial roads, bridges and tunnels – restoration of tram, bus, rail services.	Recovery support agencies: ERV and EMV Public transport operators VicTrack Victorian Managed Insurance Authority (VMIA) Road operators The SEMP Roles and Responsibilities provides detailed information on agency roles and responsibilities for recovery

6. RESPONSE: DTP SUPPORT ARRANGEMENTS

This section outlines the arrangements for public transport operators and DTP to provide support to the appointed controllers. The arrangements apply where DTP is either a control or support agency.

6.1 Role of public transport operators when DTP is a support agency

During an emergency involving a transport service disruption, DTP is the response support agency. DTP will coordinate with public transport operators to undertake this function as required. The role of a response support agency is listed in the SEMP.

The controller at each tier holds overall responsibility for the functions of control, consequence management, communication, relief (during the response phase) and recovery at that tier. They implement these functions with the involvement and support from response support agencies.

The emergency response coordinator convenes the emergency management team at the following activated tiers to coordinate the activities of response support agencies:

- Incident EMT (IEMT)
- Regional EMT (REMT)
- State EMT (SEMT)
- State Control Team

6.2 State support levels

DTP coordination, control and advice structures (refer to Figure 1) as well as three levels of activation to support transport operators:

- Level 1 relates to an operational response by individual public transport operators
- Level 2 relates to the activation of DTP support at the regional tier
- Level 3 relates to the activation of DTP support at the state tier.

6.2.1 Level 1 – response by single operator

A Level 1 situation involves single public transport operators supporting the incident controller, without the need for Departmental coordination. Typical scenarios include:

- Level 1 response situations controlled by the Public Transport Operator and/or DTP (refer Section 5 - Response: DTP control arrangements),
- power outages,
- routine police operations,
- injuries or deaths caused by medical episodes, accidents or suicide,
- fallen trees or debris from storms (unless severe storms or with a widespread impact),
- flash flooding,
- small accidents (such as level crossing accidents).

The public transport disruption is expected to be resolved within several hours.

The public transport operators responds as part of business-as-usual arrangements, in support of the Incident Controller, through the exercise of its emergency management plans and procedures. Several transport operators may be involved in the response.

Engagement with the Incident Controller is either directly, or through participation in the IEMT.

The DTP Regional Transport Coordination Team (RTC) monitors the situation and may dispatch an Emergency Management Liaison Officer (EMLO) to participate in the IEMT in place of the operator/s.


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6.2.2 Level 2 – DTP regional tier support activated

A Level 2 situation affects (or is anticipated to affect) public transport services to moderate extent, such that Departmental support is required. One or more public transport operators may be involved.

Typical scenarios may include:

- Level 2 responses controlled by DTP (refer Section 5 – Response: DTP control arrangements),
- floods or forecast of floods,
- fires or forecast of fires,
- forecast of extreme heat,
- severe weather events with significant quantity of or widespread fallen trees or debris,
- significant accident involving large vehicles, multiple vehicles or complex rescue/retrieval operations,
- widespread power outages affecting network operations, including signalling and communications.

The public transport disruption resulting from these scenarios is anticipated to take longer than 4 hours and impact on the community to resolve, but not for an extended period. Planned disruptions would not trigger a response under this Sub-Plan.

In these situations, the public transport operator continues to manage the service disruption through enacting its emergency and crisis management plans.

DTP will convene the REMT to provide oversight and support, with the AoO Controller or RAC.

Where an IEMT is also operating, the public transport operator/s may participate or, alternatively, the REMT may dispatch an EMLO to participate on their behalf.

Where multiple public transport operators respond, DTP may convene TCG to coordinate their activities.

DTP's ECT (state tier) may monitor the situation and provide support where required.

6.2.3 Level 3 – DTP state support activated

A Level 3 situation affects (or is anticipated to affect) public transport services to a large extent, requiring DTP state tier support. One or more transport operators may be involved.

Typical scenarios may include:

- Level 3 emergencies controlled by DTP (refer Section 5 - Response: DTP control arrangements)
- Class 1 emergencies
- Class 2 emergencies (e.g. pandemic or severe heat)
- Class 3 emergencies[3].

The public transport disruption resulting from these scenarios is anticipated to take an extended period to return to normal and there may be serious consequences resulting from this disruption.

At the incident tier, the transport operator continues to manage the service disruption through the exercise of its Emergency Management / Security Plan.

DTP will convene the Regional Transport Coordination Team to provide oversight and support, with the RAC participating in the REMT. Where an IEMT is also operating, the transport operator/s may participate or, alternatively, the Regional Coordination Team may dispatch an EMLO to participate on their behalf.

The DTP ECT (state tier) is activated to provide support. The SAC participates in SEMT.

DTP will convene TCG to coordinate the activities of multiple public transport operators.

The DEET will monitor the situation.

3. Refer to Appendix B for definitions of these classes of emergency.

7. RECOVERY

Under the EM Act 2013, the EMC has overall responsibility for coordination before, during and after emergencies, including the management of consequences of an emergency. Under these powers, the EMC has delegated responsibility for coordinating recovery to the Chief Executive, Emergency Recovery Victoria (ERV).

Recovery activities will be undertaken in accordance with the SEMP and will commence during the response phase. As such, high levels of understanding and cooperation are required between response and recovery organisations at each operational tier (state, regional, public transport operators) and each recovery environment and activity. Response and recovery activities may need to be managed concurrently in some areas impacted by a public transport disruption.

The recovery coordination responsibilities outlined in the 'Roles and Responsibilities' section of the SEMP, include:

- for state recovery coordination, being a Level 3 Public Transport Disruption: ERV, in consultation with DTP and Public Transport Operators
- for regional recovery coordination (including an AoO), being a Level 2 Public Transport Disruption: ERV in consultation with DTP and Public Transport Operators.

For public transport disruptions the arrangements differ from the SEMP and for Level 1 incidents recovery coordination is the responsibility of the public transport operators, as per franchise and contractual arrangements.

The nature of public transport disruption emergencies is that medium to long term recovery requirements are uncommon unless as a consequence of other emergencies.

There are specific state-level governance arrangements in place to support recovery following a major emergency, particularly the State Recovery Coordination Committee and its working groups

7.1 Transition to recovery

The SEMP specifies the arrangements for the coordinated planning and management of transition from response to recovery in Victoria.

The response function will continue at least until the impacts to public transport network assets and infrastructure are at repair and/or rebuilding phase (noting this may mean significant levels of disruption may still be present within the community).

Alternate services should be provided to the public during the transition period.

Transition plans should be developed collaboratively between Incident Controllers and Regional Controllers, as well as ERV Recovery Coordinators and public transport operators at the relevant tiers with appropriate and agreed resources, both prior to and post transition.

An important component is a seamless transition of communications, where recovery messaging should be integrated with response information as early as possible to facilitate a smooth transition to recovery, alongside other components required for effective transition to recovery.

Transition from response to recovery is not always a clearly defined step. For a public transport disruption impacting a large portion of the network, there may be a legitimate need to instigate recovery in some areas of the network while the response phase is still in operation. This is a phased transition to recovery. The teams at the relevant incident, regional and state tiers should agree on the timing and phasing of the transition, the activities required and who is responsible.

7.2 Recovery outcomes

The Victorian Recovery Outcomes Framework establishes the following long-term outcomes relevant to a public transport disruption:

- utilities and transport are effective and appropriate,
- public infrastructure is quality and relevant,
- the built environment is safe and quality,
- utilities and transport routes are restored and strengthened,
- public infrastructure is resilient and supports recovery.

The recovery outcomes aim to:

- restore transport networks to at least the state they were before the emergency event,
- assess and monitor the longer-term impact of the emergency on transport networks and infrastructure.

7.3 Agency roles and responsibilities across the lines of recovery

The recovery process, much like preparing for emergencies, is a shared responsibility between, governments, agencies, non-government organisations and communities. Victoria has a 'Resilient Recovery Strategy' which identifies four strategic actions to promote a shared responsibility approach to recovery planning and delivery. The SEMP identifies four recovery environments:

- social
- economic
- built, and
- natural.

ERV's 'Recovery Framework' builds on the SEMP, identifying five 'lines of recovery' that both align to the SEMP recovery environments and include a separate line of recovery for Aboriginal Culture and Healing:

- People and Wellbeing
- Aboriginal Culture and Healing
- Environment and Biodiversity
- Business and Economy
- Building and Infrastructure

Each of these lines of recovery have assigned responsibilities for Recovery Coordination Agencies (RecCA), Recovery Lead Agencies RecLA) and Recovery Support Agencies (RecSA). These responsibilities are outlined in the SEMP Recovery Coordination table.

7.3.1 People and wellbeing

The Department of Health (DH) is the RecCA for health and medical assistance. The Department of Families, Fairness and Housing (DFFH) is the RecCA for psychosocial support.

7.3.2 Aboriginal culture and healing

ERV is the recovery lead agency for Aboriginal culture and healing, ensuring coordination efforts align with the State Government's commitment to advancing Aboriginal self-determination. Activities in this line of recovery support the recognition of culture and knowledge, physical and mental health and wellbeing, engagement with education, respect for land practices, connection to land, water and wildlife, and strengthened representation in workforce. Recovery activities to meet these commitments span across all lines of recovery but are unified through this line of recovery and its outcomes.

7.3.3 Environment and biodiversity

The Department of Energy, Environment and Climate Action (DEECA) leads coordination of recovery activities for natural environment, public land and waterways, threatened ecosystems and species and wildlife welfare. As with all lines of recovery, the community plays a key role in supporting the delivery of these activities.

7.3.4 Business and economy

The Department of Jobs, Skills, Industry and Regions (DJSIR) is the coordinating agency for recovery activities relating to businesses and local economies. The Department of Government Services (DGS)/Local Government Victoria works closely with municipal councils to implement appropriate actions and initiatives that encourage and bring forward the resumption of local economic activity.

7.3.5 Buildings and infrastructure

DTP is the lead coordinating agency for recovery activities relating to transport. DEECA is the lead coordinating agency for recovery activities relating to energy services, public land assets and water and wastewater services. DGS leads coordination of recovery activities for public communications.


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8. PLAN PREPARATION AND APPROVAL

8.1 Consultation and engagement

Part 6A of the EM Act 2013 requires this plan to be prepared in accordance with the Act.

DTP consulted with the following public transport operators during the preparation of this Sub-Plan:

- Transit Systems Victoria
- Metro Trains Melbourne
- Yarra Trams
- V/Line
- Southern Cross Station
- Bus operators
- VicTrack
- Transurban (on behalf of CityLink and WestGate Tunnel)
- ARTC.

DTP also consulted with those which had a role in the Sub-Plan and the required agencies under the EM Act 2013.

8.2 Statement of assurance

DTP confirms:

- This Sub-Plan was prepared in accordance with the planning requirements of the EM Act 2013 and the Ministerial Guidelines for Preparing State, Regional and Municipal Emergency Management Plans.
- this Plan was last reviewed on 16 August 2024 and complete and accurate records of this review have been kept and can be provided to the relevant approver if required.

8.3 Review and urgent updates

DTP will review this Sub-Plan at least every three years, or more frequently as required, to ensure it is current, integrated, coordinated and comprehensive.

A review may be required more often where this Sub-Plan has been exercised or implemented and opportunities to improve the plan are identified.

In some circumstances, it may be necessary for DTP to update this Sub-Plan without complying with the consultation and approval requirements of the EM Act 2013. In this situation, the provisions for urgent updates in the EM Act 2013 apply.

APPENDIX A – ACRONYMS

ABBREVIATION	DEFINITION
ARTC	Australian Rail Track Corporation
AoO	Area of Operations
CBD	Central Business District
DEECA	Department of Energy, Environment, and Climate Action
DEET	Department Executive Emergency Team
DFFH	Department of Families, Fairness and Housing
DH	Department of Health
DGS	Department of Government Services
DJCS	Department of Justice and Community Safety
DJSIR	Department of Jobs, Skills, Industry and Regions
DTP	Department of Transport and Planning
ECT	Executive Coordination Team
EM Act 2013	*Emergency Management Act 2013*
EMC	Emergency Management Commissioner
EMT	Executive Management Team
EMJPIC	Emergency Management Joint Public Information Committee
EMLO	Emergency Management Liaison Officer
EMV	Emergency Management Victoria
ERV	Emergency Recovery Victoria
IMT	Incident Management Team
IEMT	Incident Emergency Management Team
IERC	Incident Emergency Response Coordinator
MEMP	Municipal Emergency Management Plan
RAC	Regional Agency Commander
RTC	Regional Transport Coordination Team
REMT	Regional Emergency Management Team
RERC	Regional Emergency Response Coordinator
SAC	State Agency Commander
SCRC	State Crisis and Resilience Council
SCT	State Control Team
SEMT	State Emergency Management Team
SEMP	State Emergency Management Plan
TCG	Transport Coordination Group
VIDA	Victorian Infrastructure Delivery Authority
WoVG	Whole-of-Victorian-Government

APPENDIX B – DEFINITIONS

Refer to the SEMP for a detailed list of emergency management terms and definitions used in Victoria.

TERM	DEFINITION
Agency	Means a government or a non-government agency. (*Emergency Management Act 1986* section 4) Agencies include government and non-government organisations, government departments, local government and volunteer organisations with a role in emergency management.
Area-of-Operations Controller	The person appointed as the controller of an area-of-operations.
Controller	The person appointed by the control agency to exercise control horizontally across responding agencies during an emergency response.
Control agency	The control agency is the agency with the primary responsibility for responding to a specific form of emergency. (*Emergency Management Act 2013* section 54)
Coordination	Coordination is the bringing together of agencies and resources to support the response to and recovery from emergencies.
Department Executive Emergency Team	DEET addresses strategic issues, is chaired by the Secretary, and includes all Deputy Secretaries. The DEET does not need to remain in situ but can convene as required for updates – either in person or online
Department	Victorian government departments, including those with portfolio responsibility for agencies with a role in emergency response.
Duty Officer	The Operational Response Duty Officer is a monitoring function through DTP's Transport Operations Centre, responsible for reviewing notifications of emergencies affecting all modes of public transport for all of Victoria. The DO provides a centralised point of contact for operators and agencies notifying DTP of an immediate or impending threat or emergency.
Executive Coordination Team	ECT addresses operational matters and is chaired by the ED Network Operations. The ECT also includes relevant Portfolio Leaders and Executive Directors as required to provide subject matter expertise.
Effective Control	Effective control is where the following conditions are met: – a control structure appropriate to the emergency is in place – controllers are working to their relevant role statement – all response decisions are consistent with the State Emergency Management Plan
Emergency Management Sector	The sector comprising all agencies, bodies, departments and other persons who have a responsibility, function or other role in emergency management. (*Emergency Management Act 2013* section 3)
Line-of-control	The line of accountability and responsibility for controllers at the incident, regional and state tiers. Issues are escalated and direction provided through the line of control.
Public Transport Operator	The individual organisations responsible for specific aspects of the transport network which carry passengers, including the train network (metropolitan and regional), tram network, bus network, and contracted ferry.

TERM	DEFINITION
Recovery	The assisting of persons and communities affected by emergencies to achieve a proper and effective level of functioning. (*Emergency Management Act 2013* section 3)
Region	A region is one of the Victorian government regions.
Relief	Provision of assistance to meet essential needs of individuals, families and communities during and in the aftermath of an emergency.
Response	The combating of emergencies and the provision of rescue services. (*Emergency Management Act 2013* section 3) For the purpose of the SEMP, emergency response is the action taken immediately before, during and in the first period after an emergency to reduce the effect and consequences of emergencies on people, their livelihoods and wellbeing, property and the environment and to meet basic human needs.
Response Agency	Any agency with a role or responsibility during an emergency response. Response agencies are either the control agency or a support agency.
State	Refers to the State Government of Victoria (or its appointments). This is to avoid confusion with the geographic 'state' of Victoria.
State Agency Commander (SAC)	A designated or rostered staff member with appropriate emergency management training and experience. The SAC ensures situational awareness for emergencies where DTP has a command or support role is communicated to our Ministers and ECT, in consultation with relevant DTP executives**.**
State Controller for Class 2 emergencies	A person appointed as a Class 2 controller at the state tier under the Emergency Management Act 2013 section 39. (*Emergency Management Act 2013* section 39)
State Emergency Management Plan	The SEMP prepared under the *Emergency Management Act 2013*.
Support Agency	A support agency is an agency that provides services, personnel, or material to support the control agency. The SEMP – Emergency Management Agency Roles lists the support agencies for specific emergencies and support agencies that provide specific services during all emergencies.

TERM	DEFINITION
Transport Coordination Group	A transport sector specific Emergency Management Team (EMT) established to provide the operational framework, subject matter expertise and essential conduits to the partner organisations necessary for coordinating the public transport response. DTP is the lead agency and coordinator of the TCG. The core membership consists of (but not limited to): – DTP – Victoria Police – Metro Trains Melbourne – Yarra Trams – V/Line – Southern Cross Station (Civic Nexus Pty Ltd) – Bus Opxerators – Bus Association of Victoria – VicTrack
Transport sector	Collective reference to the organisations contributing to the provision of transport services in Victoria
Transport operator	An individual organisation providing services within the transport sector. Transport operators include: – the operators of train, tram, bus and ferry services for either passenger or freight services – the custodial owners and operators of Victoria's transport infrastructure, including for rail, road and port operations – the operators of key transport nodes, such as bridges, intermodal hubs and depots.
Transport service disruption	A situation where the transport operator's ability to operate its contracted scheduled services is impeded.
Whole of Victorian Government	For the purpose of the SEMP, the whole of government is a collective term for all agencies with a role or responsibility in emergency management in Victoria, as listed in SEMP – Emergency Management Agency Roles.

APPENDIX C – RESPONSE LEVELS AND TRIGGER POINTS

	LEVEL 1 RESPONSE (TRANSPORT OPERATOR RESPONSE)	LEVEL 2 RESPONSE (REGIONAL TIER ACTIVATED)[4]	LEVEL 3 RESPONSE (STATE TIER ACTIVATED)
Potential impact on transport services	Full or partial suspension of services for a limited time	Service disruption for more than 4 hours outside planned disruptions.	Extended service disruption
Emergencies controlled by DTP or Operators	Potential scenarios include: – significant cancellation of services – rolling stock or network infrastructure faults or emergencies – minor infrastructure and resource planning issues – loss of telecommunication.	Potential scenarios include: – small scale telecommunication outage possibly causing network signalling issues and failure to communicate with multiple transport modes – a situation where a Infrastructure provider was unable to deliver services and the services of a number of public transport operators were affected – non planned transport disruption situations anticipated to take longer than 4 hours to resolve.	Potential scenarios include: – widespread and protracted telecommunications outage potentially causing signalling issues and failures to communicate with transport nodes (Class 2 emergency) – a major infrastructure failure with the risk of loss of life and multiple injuries (Class 2 emergency)
Emergencies controlled by other agencies	– non major power outages – routine police operations – injuries or deaths caused by medical episodes, accidents or suicide – fallen trees or debris from storms – flash flooding – small accidents (such as level crossing accidents).	– floods – fires or forecast of fires – forecast of extreme heat – significant accident involving large vehicles, multiple vehicles or complex rescue/retrieval operations – Widespread power outages affecting network operations, including signalling and communications.	Major emergencies or emergency with the potential to become: – Class 1 emergency – other Class 2 emergency – Class 3 emergency
DTP support	Regional Transport Coordination team(RTC) monitoring	RTC activated DTP SAC and SDO monitoring	DTP SAC and SDO activated ECT Activated DEET monitoring

4 Note: where an emergency crosses more than two regions, an Area of Operations may be created. If this were to occur it will operate as a regional tier.


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